

Luis Fernando Palacios Flores

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Education

M.Sc. in Data Science and Artificial Intelligence

University of Trieste, Trieste, Italy

Sep 2023 – Sep 2025

GPA: 110/110 cum laude

B.Sc. in Physics

Escuela Politécnica Nacional, Quito, Ecuador

Apr 2017 – Nov 2022

GPA: 26.10/30

Master in Data Management and Curation (postgraduate course)

SISSA and Area Science Park, Trieste, Italy

Sep 2025 – Jun 2026

Research

Master's Thesis, Laboratory of Data Engineering, Area Science Park

Mar 2025 – May 2026

- Showed, with Lorenzo Basile, Diego Doimo, and Alberto Cazzaniga, that visual instruction tuning aligns image and text in the intermediate layers of a vision-language model. Tuning that band on LLaVA-7B and OneVision-4B matches full fine-tuning on the vision benchmarks and uses less training time.
- Lorenzo Basile, Diego Doimo, and Alberto Cazzaniga designed the core experiments. I developed the codebase and ran the experiments with Lorenzo Basile and Diego Doimo. Equal contribution with Lorenzo Basile.
- **Publication:** Luis Palacios*, Lorenzo Basile*, Diego Doimo, Alberto Cazzaniga. [Visual Instruction Tuning Aligns Modalities through Abstraction](#). Accepted as a poster, NeurIPS 2026. 📄

Data Management and Curation, Area Science Park

Nov 2025 – Jun 2026

- Built Buckets Explorer, a web app for managing S3 buckets on Area Science Park's storage, and deployed it on Kubernetes. [code](#) [site](#) [DOI](#)
- Built a generator that deploys asynchronous, metered machine-learning APIs on Kubernetes. The reference services classify scanning-electron-microscope images. [code](#) [DOI](#)

Work Experience

Teaching Technician, EPN, Quito, Ecuador

May - Aug 2023

- Supervised physics lab sessions, reinforcing students' conceptual understanding and critical thinking.
- Assessed lab reports and provided feedback to improve scientific rigor and analytical writing.

Skills

Programming: Python, PyTorch, C++, Kubernetes, Git, Linux

Languages: Spanish (native), English (C1), Italian (A1)

Extracurricular Activities and Achievements

Research & Study Fellowships — MDMC — LADE research fellowship; SISSA fee scholarship

2025 - 2026

Merit-Based Study Fellowship — DSAI — SISSA; Collegio Fonda (Trieste, Italy)

2023 - 2025

Vice-President of the Theoretical Physics Club 🌐, EPN

Nov 2021 - Mar 2023

- Organized physics and programming workshops and maintained club GitHub repositories. 🌐

References

Dr. Alberto Cazzaniga, thesis advisor. Dr. Diego Doimo, thesis advisor.

References available on request.